

■ Additional Committee Considerations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Report." Items, listed by committee, are summarized as follows:

AGENDA

The committee discussed Conference presentation/discussions and took no action to limit their number or preclude them from the 2018 Conference agenda, noting topics selected for 2018 were important for discussion at the Conference; with a low number of responses to the 2016 Conference Evaluation Form it was agreed to emphasize that all Conference members have an obligation to participate and encouraged efforts to make the form more focused and user-friendly; appreciation was noted for the additional communication and larger role for delegates in the selection of agenda items, with a request that information be gathered from 2018 Conference committee chairs and an enhanced role for delegates continue to be explored; it was requested that the grid of proposed Conference agenda items be updated to show the disposition of items by the trustees' committees and that it be posted to the dashboard as soon as possible following the January Board Weekend; no action was taken on a request to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

ARCHIVES*

No action was taken on a request to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference; the committee suggested refreshing the "Shared

Experiences" section of the Archives Workbook with new stories from local archivists and adding a new section to the "Archives and History" portal of the G.S.O. website to include updates from G.S.O. Archives.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY COMMITTEE

The committee requested that the trustees' Committee on Cooperation with the Professional Community/Treatment and Accessibilities continue to explore establishing a presence on LinkedIn as a tool for C.P.C. efforts and develop a full report that includes an exploration of all aspects of this social media tool and possibilities for implementation; improving communication about A.A. with professionals who come in contact with veterans and active members of the Armed Services was discussed and a number of suggestions made; no action was taken on a request to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference; the C.P.C. Kit and Workbook were reviewed, with the suggestion that the sample guide letters to various professionals be reviewed and updated to ensure that the language used is current and relevant to the professionals to whom they are addressed.

CORRECTIONS

The committee discussed raising awareness of the Corrections Correspondence Service (C.C.S.) in Canada and its benefits to both "inside" and "outside" members, making a number of suggestions and asking G.S.O. staff and the trustees' Committee on Corrections to look into additional options that could encourage broader utilization; carrying the A.A. message to incarcerated Native American/First Nations/Inuit People was discussed with agreement that local committees were best able to handle this important work, though to aid in carrying the message to this population, the committee suggested adding the pamphlet "Many Paths to Spirituality" to the Corrections Kit and the Corrections Group Handbook; the committee noted that some incarcerated French and Spanish members have difficulty with subtitles in the video "A New Freedom," and requested that A.A.W.S. make the message more accessible and consider developing a service piece to accompany the video.

FINANCE

The committee agreed that the Conference-approved level of \$5,000 for individual bequests to the General Service Board from A.A. members is an appropriate amount at this time; self-support efforts and materials were discussed with suggestions made for the Self-Support Packet, the Self-Support Card, the service piece "The A.A. Group Treasurer" and other aspects of communicating with the Fellowship about the



spiritual message of Seventh Tradition contributions; communication about recurring contributions was discussed along with possibility of using an app to further increase carrying the message of recovery and self-support; the committee requested the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee develop a list of Conference-approved literature where adding language regarding online and recurring contributions is appropriate and report back to the 2018 Conference Finance Committee.

GRAPEVINE

The committee discussed the spiritual value of Grapevine and La Viña in carrying the message of Alcoholics Anonymous and agreed that the magazines are important Twelfth Step tools, recognizing that Grapevine and La Viña cannot accept contributions and are self-supporting only through subscriptions and sales of books and other items; it was suggested that the Grapevine Board create a plan for outside sales of subscriptions, books and other items and report back to the 2018 Conference Committee on Grapevine; continued exploration of Instagram, Facebook and Google for Nonprofits accounts was discussed with a request for additional information and plans to be brought back to the 2018 Conference Committee on Grapevine for consideration; it was suggested that all delegates consider it a part of their responsibility to inform the Fellowship about Grapevine and La Viña as tools of sobriety, either through their own efforts or by recruiting others through email and area websites; the committee forwarded a number of suggestions to the A.A. Grapevine Board for items to be produced in the year 2018 or later and additions to the Grapevine workbook; an update on the 2017 Grapevine Office Report on Audio Strategy was requested for the 2018 Conference Committee on the Grapevine.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTIONS/ REGIONAL FORUMS*

The committee discussed ways of encouraging interest in Regional Forums to attract first-time attendees and made a number of suggestions; the committee reviewed the 2030 International Convention Site-Selection Procedures; no action was taken to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

LITERATURE

The committee discussed but took no action on a request to retire the pamphlet "Too Young?"; after reviewing draft revisions or progress reports, the committee offered editorial suggestions for "Young People and A.A.," "A.A. for the Woman," "Finding Acceptance: A.A. for the LGBTQ Alcoholic" (formerly "A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic"), "The Twelve Traditions Illustrated," "Inside A.A.: Understanding the Fellowship and Its Services," and a pamphlet-in-progress for alcoholics with mental health issues and those who sponsor them, with the understanding that revised drafts or progress reports, where appropriate, would be brought back at the 2018 General

Service Conference; a request was made that the trustees' Public Information Committee consider adding information related to safety to the pamphlets "A Brief Guide to A.A." and "Understanding Anonymity"; the committee considered requests for the development of new literature regarding safety in A.A. and took no action, agreeing that shared experience regarding safety and A.A. would be best conveyed by revising existing literature, where appropriate, and noting that the new service piece, "Safety and A.A.: Our Common Welfare," has been found helpful in providing experience from groups and members on challenges, resources and possible solutions in situations that may involve the safety of groups or individual members; no action was taken on a request to add a section "Why A.A. groups and members should respect the rental requirements of their landlords" to the pamphlet "The A.A. Group," as it was agreed that an A.A. group's relationship with their landlord falls within the autonomy of the group.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

The committee discussed but took no action on requests for regional service committees to bid on hosting the General Service Conference, that the Advisory Action delegating site selection for the General Service Conference to G.S.O. management be rescinded, that a "YPAA Subcommittee" be added to the service structure, and that text be added to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

The committee reviewed and accepted reports from the trustees' Public Information Committee regarding aa.org and aagrapevine.org, the Comprehensive Media Plan, and Carrying the Message Online and on Social Media, and requested that the trustees' committee continue to develop their ideas on the use of quick response (QR) codes, a video on anonymity and the Internet, and a daily text message, along with the development of service materials to address frequently asked questions regarding anonymity online and in social media, noting that the service piece "Anonymity Online" is still a valuable resource; information was reviewed and accepted on centralized distribution, tracking and evaluation of the public service announcement "I Have Hope"; suggestions were made that the trustees' Committee on Public Information continue to research the feasibility of A.A.W.S. using Google AdWords and Google Grants and bring a report to the 2018 Conference Committee on Public Information; a report from the trustees' Public Information Committee on the implementation of a Twitter account was reviewed with no action taken and continued pursuit of options for carrying the A.A. message to the public on social media was suggested; specific suggestions were offered for the pamphlet "Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings" to include revised text regarding the source of information identifying one-third of A.A. members as women and adding website information as needed; the contents of the P.I. Kit and Workbook were reviewed; no action was taken to add text to the

*Members serve on this committee as a secondary committee assignment.



committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

REPORT AND CHARTER

The committee discussed and accepted reports outlining the General Service Office process for preparation and publication of *The A.A. Service Manual*, 2018-2020 Edition and the 2017 *Final Conference Report*; the complexities involved in biennial production of *The A.A. Service Manual* were discussed, noting that the process is still in its infancy and that substantive changes to the Service Manual can be found in the *Final Conference Report* as well as the Report and Charter Conference Committee's History and Highlights of Actions in years that a revised edition is not published; suggested revisions were offered to the proposed Service Manual updates from the General Service Board and the A.A. Grapevine Board; a plan for a revised editorial review process was requested to be brought back to the 2018 Conference Committee on Report and Charter along with suggestions on how changes to *The A.A. Service Manual* could be reported to the Fellowship in non-printing years; it was suggested that footnotes be added to *The A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts for World Service* to accurately reflect in Concept VIII the current ownership of the service corporations as presented in Footnote 3, Concept XI, and that the year A.A.W.S., Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. became membership corporations in the state of New York be added to both footnotes; no action was taken to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

TREATMENT AND ACCESSIBILITIES

The committee reviewed the Treatment Service Kit and made several suggestions for revisions; it was suggested that the title, menu and introduction to the DVD and CD currently titled "A.A. for the Alcoholic with Special Needs" be revised to "Accessibility for All Alcoholics," with subtitles in French and Spanish for the DVD; ways of incorporating shared experience in carrying the A.A. message to members of the Armed Services were discussed, including sharing at the pre-Conference Remote Communities meeting and translation of the pamphlet "A.A. and the Armed

Services" into French and Spanish and adding it to the Accessibilities Kit; a request was made that the General Service Office continue exploring strategies to provide more effective services to alcoholics who are veterans and active members of the Armed Services and provide a progress report to the 2018 Conference Committee on Treatment and Accessibilities; no action was taken to add text to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure regarding the option to meet by conference call prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference.

TRUSTEES

The committee approved as eligible for election all Class B trustee candidates and discussed the voting procedures for electing trustee-at-large/U.S. and a request to consider the need to restructure the number of regions and number of regional trustees serving on the General Service Board; a progress report was requested from the trustees' Committee on Nominating to the 2018 Conference Committee on Trustees reviewing available information on regional geographical structure, including consideration of each regional trustees' ability to effectively serve his or her areas, consideration of geographical factors and whether an equal or similar number of areas per region is desirable, as well as feasibility and cost analysis.

Recommendations Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

CORRECTIONS

- The following text be added to the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Corrections:

In order to assist Conference committees in handling their workload, if a Conference committee feels it is helpful to complete the work of their committee, they are welcome to meet via conference call in the 60 days prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference. They may use the call for such things as deciding how to conduct their business, including the means of voting within the committee, reordering the items on their agenda if needed, and holding preliminary non-voting discussions on what they consider to be priority agenda items. Conference committee secretaries would be available to facilitate these meetings. **(Withdrawn by the committee)**

FINANCE

- The Conference-approved maximum annual contribution to the General Service Board from an individual A.A. member of \$3,000 be increased to \$5,000. **(Not approved)**
- The following text be added to the pamphlet "Self-Support: Where Money and Spirituality Mix": "Question: Are there limits to the amount of money an A.A. group or an A.A. event can contribute to G.S.O.? Answer: No," and include this language in all appropriate service material. **(Not approved)**

- The following text be added to the committee's Composition, Scope and Procedure:

The committee may meet by conference call in the 60 days prior to Conference for such things as deciding how to conduct their business, including the means of voting within the committee, reordering the items on their agenda if needed, and holding preliminary non-voting discussions on what they consider to be priority items. **(Withdrawn by the committee)**

GRAPEVINE

- The following text be added to the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Grapevine under procedures:

In order to assist the committee in handling its workload, the committee is welcome to meet via conference call in the 60 days prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference. They may use the call for such things as deciding how to conduct their business, including the means of voting within the committee, reordering the items on their agenda if needed, and holding preliminary non-voting discussions on what they consider to be priority agenda items. Conference committee secretaries would be available to facilitate these meetings. **(Withdrawn by the committee)**

LITERATURE

- The following text be added to the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Literature under procedures:

In order to assist the committee in handling its workload, the committee is welcome to meet via conference call in the 60 days prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference. They may use the call for such things as deciding how to conduct their business, including the means of voting within the committee, reordering the items on their agenda if needed, and holding preliminary non-voting discussions on what they consider to be priority agenda items. Conference committee secretaries would be available to facilitate these meetings. **(Withdrawn by the committee)**

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- Option 2 in the Final Report on the Translation of Conference Background be implemented for the Spanish language only for a three-year trial period, and that an annual report from the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference be presented for review by the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. **(Recommitted to trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference)**
- The General Service Conference be held in New York City every other year. **(Not approved)**

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The 2017 A.A. Membership Survey be conducted by area on a random basis as was done in the 2014 A.A. Membership Survey and requested that the trustees' Committee on Public Information review the current

A.A. Membership Survey methodology, possible methods for surveying the membership electronically and any reasonable hybrid of the two methods, and that a progress report be brought back to the 2018 Conference Committee on Public Information. **(Not approved)**

- The draft 2017 A.A. Survey Questionnaire be changed as follows:

Question 2 be changed from "Sex: ___ Male ___ Female" to "Gender Identity: ___ Male ___ Female ___ [language to include all gender nonconforming] ___ No Response" **(Recommitted to trustees' Committee on Public Information)**

TRUSTEES

- The following text be added to the Composition, Scope and Procedure of the Conference Committee on Trustees:

In order to assist Conference committees in handling their workload, if a Conference committee feels it is helpful to complete the work of their committee, they are welcome to meet via conference call in the 60 days prior to the Annual Meeting of the General Service Conference. They may use the call for such things as deciding how to conduct their business, including the means of voting within the committee, reordering the items on their agenda if needed, and holding preliminary non-voting discussions on what they consider to be priority agenda items. Conference committee secretaries would be available to facilitate these meetings. **(Withdrawn by the committee)**

Floor Actions Not Resulting in Conference Advisory Actions

- In order to reduce the current annual cost of more than \$50,000 and set an example for the Fellowship regarding our principles of rotation and financial prudence, the General Service Board develop a plan to allow no more than the immediate past chair of the General Service Board and two other emeritus trustees to attend each Board Weekend and the annual General Service Conference. **(Not approved)**
- The Conference adopt Option 1 on the translation of Conference background material into Spanish and French as it is presented in the agenda and background for Policy/Admissions. **(Withdrawn)**
- That the submission letters for proposed agenda items be placed on the Conference dashboard. **(Not approved)**
- The General Service Board develop a policy regarding limits on contributions to the board from groups and other A.A. entities, recognizing that groups and entities are autonomous in regard to both giving and accepting contributions. A draft text or progress report be brought to the appropriate committee of the 2018 General Service Conference. **(Conference declined to consider)**
- The General Service Conference of A.A. extend an invitation to the YPAA to have two of their members attend the 2018 General Service Conference as observers. **(Conference declined to consider)**